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Article

When Reality Moves

Sue Broughton

Gaia Nexus Online

August 29, 2026

An AI system is approved for use across an organisation.

At the time, the decision is well supported.

Authority is clear. The policy is current. Human review is adequate. Exception volumes are manageable. Experienced people are available. Intervention is practical. Recovery mechanisms are sufficient.

The system is deployed.

Six months later, it is still performing well.

There has been no major breach. No catastrophic failure. The AI remains within its permissions. The controls are working.

But the organisation around it has changed.

Review demand has become concentrated among fewer people. Expert utilisation has increased. Some of the first level work humans previously performed has disappeared. Exceptions have become more complex. The AI provider has changed the model. People responsible for oversight have moved roles. The system has expanded into workflows that were not part of the original deployment.

Nothing necessarily failed.

The original decision may have been completely reasonable.

But are the conditions that made it reasonable still the same?

Mo Johnson captured the problem in one sentence:

The decision isn't always what fails. Sometimes reality just moves on.

That creates a different governance question:

What evidence do we still have that allows us to rely on the conditions under which this system was originally approved?

And perhaps an even simpler principle:

If something matters enough for an organisation to rely upon, it matters enough to know whether it is still there.

Organisations Do Not Passively Absorb Change

After the previous article in this series, Ravi Shankar NRK raised five questions that pushed this problem considerably further.

His first was about what organisations do when AI redistributes work.

Unlike a physical structure, organisations adapt.

People create workarounds.

They develop shadow processes.

They may begin approving AI outputs more quickly to clear growing queues.

Difficult cases may become concentrated among fewer experienced people.

Work may quietly migrate somewhere else.

Or people may leave.

Ravi asked:

What maladaptive behavior did the system invent to disguise the fact that it was overloaded?

That is an important question because an organisation can appear to be coping precisely because its people are compensating for pressures that conventional reporting does not show.

The AI may be working.

Throughput may be increasing.

Service levels may remain acceptable.

No control may have failed.

But the way the organisation is sustaining that performance may have changed considerably.

The absence of failure is not necessarily evidence that the conditions surrounding the AI remain healthy.

Sometimes adaptation itself is the signal.

Human Capability May Be Changing, Not Declining

Ravi's second challenge corrected an assumption that is easy to make when discussing AI and human capability.

If AI removes work, it does not necessarily follow that human judgement is deteriorating.

Suppose a junior analyst no longer reviews hundreds of straightforward transactions because AI handles them.

That analyst may have lost one developmental pathway.

But perhaps they are now dealing with far more difficult exceptions.

Their judgement may be weakening.

It may be strengthening.

Or it may simply be developing differently.

That distinction matters.

Reduced human participation cannot automatically be treated as capability loss.

The better question is:

Are the human capabilities the organisation now depends upon still being developed and remaining available as the work changes?

AI may remove one route through which expertise developed while creating another.

It may also preserve access to organisational knowledge without necessarily preserving the human capability to interpret it.

Documents, audit trails and knowledge bases can remain completely intact while fewer people retain the experience to recognise what is missing, reconstruct context or challenge a plausible answer.

So capability continuity is not simply about preserving information. It is also about preserving the human capacity to make sense of it.

The governance problem is not to preserve yesterday's work simply because humans once performed it.

It is to understand what capabilities the organisation will continue to need, how those capabilities are now being developed, and whether they will still be available when required.

That turns human capability from a headcount question into a continuity question.

What Is Structural Headroom Worth?

Ravi's third question is harder.

In the previous article, I argued that apparently unused organisational capacity can sometimes provide structural headroom.

An experienced person who appears underutilised may become critical when an unusual case arrives.

A review function with spare capacity may suddenly matter when AI activity doubles.

An escalation pathway that is rarely used may become essential when something unexpected occurs.

From an efficiency perspective, however, unused capacity can look wasteful.

And Ravi asked the question a COO or CFO should ask:

How do we put a defensible dollar value on that headroom?

We do not yet have a complete answer to that.

A defensible valuation would need to compare the immediate saving from removing capacity with the economic exposure created by losing it.

What would it cost to rebuild the capability later?

What would it cost to replace scarce expertise externally?

What would happen if exception demand suddenly increased?

What is the economic consequence of slower recovery, insufficient review capacity or an inability to scale the AI safely?

What would it cost to recreate a developmental pathway after it had disappeared?

That suggests one possible direction, some of the value of structural headroom may be understood through the cost and difficulty of reconstructing what has been removed.

But turning that into a reliable financial method requires further work.

That matters because if structural headroom is going to survive an efficiency review, governance eventually has to make its economic value visible as well as its operational value.

Otherwise an organisation may optimise away something whose value becomes apparent only after it is gone.

Can We Actually See Change Happening?

Ravi's fourth question goes to the practical heart of the problem.

It is easy to say that organisations should monitor changing dependency, human capability, oversight and recovery capacity.

But what is the actual evidence?

Without that answer, longitudinal governance risks becoming something we explain after a problem rather than something that helps us recognise change while it is developing.

The evidence does not have to come from a new coherence sensor.

Much of it already exists inside the organisation.

Review timestamps can show whether meaningful review windows are compressing.

Escalation and override records can show whether challenge behaviour is changing.

Workflow and exception records can show where difficult work is accumulating and who is carrying it.

Utilisation data can show whether critical expertise is becoming concentrated or approaching saturation.

Records of workarounds, recovery events and changes in task allocation can show how the operating model itself is shifting.

And structured periodic Human Readiness assessment can examine capabilities that operational records cannot directly reveal.

The important point is not any one measure.

It is the ability to bring different forms of evidence together over time and ask whether several conditions the organisation depends upon are moving together.

This is longitudinal observation.

Its cadence will depend on the condition being observed. Some operational evidence may be available continuously or routinely through existing systems. Other questions, particularly those concerning human capability, judgement and readiness, require structured periodic assessment.

It is not the same as runtime monitoring.

Nor does every movement indicate deterioration.

The purpose is to make material change visible early enough for an authorised person to investigate what it means.

Small Changes Can Become Material Together

This matters because organisational change does not always arrive as an incident.

A little more pressure here.

A little less capacity there.

A gradual change in how people challenge AI.

More reliance on a smaller number of experts.

A changing mix of work.

A slow shift in where judgement is exercised.

Individually, none may warrant intervention.

Together, they may describe a very different organisation.

The organisation can pass every individual checkpoint while gradually moving away from the conditions that made the original operating model sensible.

The question therefore cannot simply be:

Has something changed?

Something almost certainly has.

The better question is:

Has something changed that matters to what the organisation is relying upon?

Seeing Change Does Not Tell Us Why

There is an important boundary here.

Minas Papagiannopoulos challenged the distinction between what we can observe and what we can legitimately say caused it.

Suppose expert utilisation rises, review times fall and challenge behaviour changes after AI is introduced.

Those observations matter.

But they do not prove that AI caused them.

The organisation may also have restructured.

Demand may have increased.

People may have left.

Budgets may have changed.

Management incentives may have shifted.

That means the evidence needs to move through a disciplined sequence:

Detection → Association → Attribution

First, detect what changed.

Then investigate which changes appear related.

Only attribute cause when the evidence supports it.

Better visibility should not give a governance system permission to make stronger claims than the evidence allows.

Sometimes the correct report is simply:

Something important is changing here. We need to understand why.

What We Know May No Longer Be What Is True Now

A discussion between Tim Zlomke and Stephen Calhoun exposed another dimension of the same problem.

Stephen described an approach in which authority, scope, parameter limits, prerequisites and human approval can be checked before an AI action reaches a real system.

Tim then asked a deeper question:

How does the system know that the information it is checking is still current?

A system may be able to establish that something agrees with the latest information available to it.

That does not necessarily prove that reality outside its view has not changed.

Which gives us an important distinction:

Latest known state is not necessarily actual current state.

The same problem exists at organisational level.

The approval still exists.

The policy is still on file.

The audit trail is intact.

The authorised role still exists.

But do those records still describe the organisation operating today?

Historical evidence can tell us why a decision was reasonable when it was made.

It does not automatically tell us whether the conditions supporting that decision remain present now.

That is why the starting point for longitudinal governance should not simply be a snapshot of how the organisation looked before AI was deployed.

It should be the **conditions the organisation actually relied upon when it made the decision.**

Those conditions may be recoverable even for an AI system that has already been operating for years.

They may sit in the business case.

The risk assessment.

The control design.

The approval record.

The operating assumptions.

The conditions attached to sign-off.

The important question is:

What did we rely upon when we decided this was safe, appropriate and workable, and what evidence tells us those things are still true?

Some Problems Cannot Wait for a Human

Ravi's fifth challenge establishes another important boundary.

If an AI system is operating at machine speed and something goes seriously wrong, human intervention may simply be too slow to function as the primary safety mechanism.

He is right.

Some failures must be prevented or contained by the architecture itself.

Permissions, runtime controls, hard limits, deterministic checks, security controls and structural containment remain essential.

Longitudinal governance addresses a different problem.

It asks what is happening to the organisation around those controls over time.

Are the humans those controls depend upon still capable of performing their role?

Is intervention still practical where human intervention is expected?

Are recovery mechanisms still adequate?

Are assumptions that were reasonable when the system was approved still reasonable now?

The distinction matters.

Runtime controls contain what must not be allowed to happen.

Longitudinal governance helps the organisation recognise when the conditions surrounding its AI have materially changed.

One does not replace the other.

Making Change Governable

This is the territory we are exploring through **Coherence Centric Governance (CCG).**

CCG starts by identifying the conditions the organisation relied upon when the AI operating model was approved.

It then identifies the evidence capable of showing whether those conditions continue to hold.

That evidence can come from operational records, workflow and utilisation data, review and escalation activity, documented changes to the operating environment and structured assessment of human capability and readiness.

Over time, CCG looks for meaningful movement across those sources.

Not simply whether something is different from the past, but whether conditions important to the organisation's continuing reliance on the AI are changing.

When material change becomes visible, CCG can bring the relevant evidence together and report it in a form an authorised person can assess.

The aim is not for the AI to make the governance decision.

It is to give the authorised person enough timely, structured evidence to understand what has changed, investigate why, and decide whether the original assumptions still deserve reliance.

That is why I would slightly reframe Ravi's question about governing the “between.”

The role of CCG is not to become the authority governing everything that happens between formal control points.

It is to make the “between” governable.

The distinction is fundamental.

The AI observes and reports. The authorised human decides.

What This Means for a CEO

Approval cannot be treated as a permanent property of an operating system.

That does not mean continuously reopening every decision or creating another layer of bureaucracy around every AI deployment.

It means retaining enough evidence to know when the conditions supporting an earlier decision deserve another look.

In simple terms, you should not assume that because an AI system is still performing well and has not breached its controls, the organisation around it is still in the same condition as when you approved it.

Know what you relied upon when that decision was made.

Perhaps it was experienced people being available to review difficult cases.

Enough time for meaningful judgement.

Working escalation pathways.

Capacity to absorb exceptions.

The ability to intervene and recover.

People continuing to develop expertise the organisation would need later.

Then know what evidence would tell you if those conditions began to change.

Not every change requires action.

Some changes may strengthen the organisation.

But when something important to the original operating assumptions materially changes, the person with authority needs to see the evidence and decide what it means.

The practical requirement is remarkably simple:

Know what you relied upon.

Know what evidence tells you it is still there.

Know when that evidence changes.

Make sure the person with authority sees it and can decide what to do.

That is governance continuity.

Four Questions, One Larger Problem

Across these four articles, the questions have progressively moved outward.

The first asked:

Your AI saved $5 million. How much did the business actually keep?

The second:

The metric may be accurate. But does it accurately represent what happened?

The third:

When AI changes one part of the organisation, what else moves?

And now:

When the organisation has moved, what are we still entitled to rely upon from the original decision?

Together they take us from:

Value → Representation → Redistribution → Continuing Reliance

And perhaps the simplest principle emerging from this fourth question is this:

If something matters enough for an organisation to rely upon, it matters enough to know whether it is still there.

This is not an argument for continuously reopening every decision.

It is an argument for retaining enough evidence to know when the foundations beneath a decision deserve another look.

Because sometimes the AI doesn't break the rules.

Sometimes the rules don't break either.

Reality simply moves.

Next: from principle to practice — what does a CCG report actually show an enterprise?

My thanks to Ravi Shankar NRK, whose five questions following the previous article helped sharpen the structure of this one; to Mo Johnson for the observation that helped crystallise its central question; to Minas Papagiannopoulos for pushing the distinction between observation and causation; to Evelyne-Claudia Yantony for sharpening the question of cumulative materiality; and to Tim Zlomke and Stephen Calhoun, whose exchange helped clarify the distinction between what is latest known and what is actually current.

Post

https://www.linkedin.com/feed/update/urn:li:ugcPost:7499361466093826048/

Sometimes nothing actually fails. Reality simply moves.

An AI system can still be performing well.
The controls can still be working.
The original approval can still have been completely reasonable.

And yet the conditions that made that decision reasonable may no longer be the same.
That is the governance problem this fourth article explores.
Because organisations don't stand still around AI.

Work moves. Expertise moves. Human capability develops differently. Review pressure changes. Dependencies deepen. Operating assumptions gradually shift.

So perhaps the question isn't only whether the AI is still operating within its approval.

It is:
What evidence do we still have that allows us to rely on the conditions under which it was originally approved?

And that leads to a principle I think sits at the heart of longitudinal AI governance:
If something matters enough for an organisation to rely upon, it matters enough to know whether it is still there.

This article explores what that could mean in practice and how Coherence Centric Governance (CCG) could help make the changing space between formal governance decisions visible and governable.

Full article attached.

Image

Comments

Evelyne-Claudia Yantony • 1stVerified • 1st

AI Governance & Ethical Intelligence | Author | Scientific Contributor — NeoMundi Research | Living Architecture & Reachable

16h

Thank you, Sue. Yes — I think that is precisely where the two questions meet.
Recognition tells us that the basis for continuing reliance may have changed. Reachability asks the next operational question: can evidence of that change still reach legitimate authority, and can that authority still alter what happens next before consequence becomes difficult or impossible to reverse?
That distinction matters because a system may successfully detect a material change and still remain effectively governed by an obsolete warrant if the corrective pathway no longer has causal reach.
And I am especially glad we agree on provenance. Independent convergence becomes more meaningful, not less, when the separate

paths remain visible. It lets us distinguish what each line of inquiry discovered from what became clearer when they met.
Thank you for sharpening this with me, Sue.

Like

2

Reply2 replies2 Replies on Evelyne-Claudia Yantony’s comment

Sue Broughton Premium**Author**

Gaia Nexus Online

16h

Evelyne-Claudia Yantony Thank you, Evelyne. Excellent I think we have reached the important distinction. Recognition without reachability can leave material change visible but operationally powerless. And reachability without sound recognition gives authority little meaningful evidence on which to act.

So the two really do meet at the point where evidence of material change can still reach legitimate authority while that authority retains meaningful capacity to alter what happens next.

And completely agreed on provenance. Keeping the separate paths visible makes the convergence more informative because we can see not only where the ideas meet, but what each brought to that meeting. Thank you for such a thoughtful exchange.

Like

1

Reply

10 impressions

[**Evelyne-Claudia Yantony** • 1stVerified • 1st]

[AI Governance & Ethical Intelligence | Author | Scientific Contributor — NeoMundi Research | Living Architecture & Reachable]

16h

Sue Broughton Sue, thank you — yes. I think this identifies the junction beautifully.
Recognition makes material change epistemically available; reachability determines whether that evidence can still become operationally effective governance. The consequential question is therefore not simply whether the change has been seen, but whether evidence of it can still reach legitimate authority while that authority retains the meaningful capacity to alter what happens next.
And I completely agree about keeping the separate paths visible. Convergence becomes much more informative when we preserve not only where ideas meet, but what each lineage brought to the meeting.
Thank you for such a careful and generous exchange, Sue.

Like

Reply

Collapse replies

N . G . Z . • 1st1st

Audit & Regulatory Verification Consultant | Data Integrity | Enterprise Risk & Compliance Frameworks

22h

⚜️ Spot on, Sue. The fundamental vulnerability in legacy AI oversight is treating authorization as a static milestone rather than a dynamic state of evidence. When baseline operating conditions shift—whether through environmental drift, human-in-the-loop capacity dilution, or ecosystem dependencies—the initial risk validation matrix effectively collapses.

To achieve true continuity, enterprise governance must transition from periodic qualitative reviews to continuous deterministic evidence verification. If the underlying operational premises cannot be continuously proven, approval isn't just outdated—it is non-compliant .

Like

2

Reply1 reply1 Comment on N . G . Z .'s comment

Sue Broughton Premium**Author**

Gaia Nexus Online

21h

N . G . Z . Thank you NGZ, I think the shift from authorisation as a historical event to continuing evidence is exactly where the governance challenge is moving.

I would make one distinction, though. Some operating conditions can be evidenced continuously or routinely through system records, but others, particularly human judgement, readiness and governing capability, cannot necessarily be reduced to continuous deterministic verification. They may require structured periodic assessment alongside the operational evidence.

So for me, continuity is not about continuously reproving the entire approval. It is about retaining enough evidence to recognise when a condition the organisation relied upon has materially changed, so the authorised human can determine whether the original decision still deserves reliance.

That distinction between continuous evidence where possible and continuing evidence where necessary may be an important one.

Like

1

Reply

35 impressions

[**N . G . Z .** • 1st1st]

[Audit & Regulatory Verification Consultant | Data Integrity | Enterprise Risk & Compliance Frameworks]

20h

[**Sue Broughton**] Spot on distinction, Sue. Human readiness and qualitative judgment are non-linear capabilities that cannot be compressed into raw telemetry.

The synergy lies in their architectural interface: continuous deterministic verification functions as the underlying sensor layer—monitoring environmental drift, capacity dilution, and boundary shifts. Rather than replacing human governance, this telemetry serves as an event-driven trigger, signaling precisely when structured human re-assessment is warranted.

By shifting enterprise oversight from arbitrary calendar-driven reviews to real-time signal-driven triggers, we ensure human experts intervene exactingly when operating premises erode—seamlessly bridging continuous evidence with continuing human oversight.

Like

2

Reply1 reply1 Comment on N . G . Z .'s comment

Sue Broughton Premium**Author**

Gaia Nexus Online

16h

N . G . Z . Yes, I think we are very close here. The interface you describe is important: continuous operational evidence can identify changes that warrant structured human reassessment, without pretending that human judgement or readiness can themselves be reduced to telemetry.

I would retain one additional safeguard, though. Signal driven reassessment can complement rather than necessarily replace periodic assessment, because some changes in human capability may not produce a reliable operational signal before they matter.

So perhaps the architecture becomes: continuous evidence where it can be observed, periodic assessment where it cannot, and event driven human reassessment when material change is detected.
That gives us a much stronger bridge between continuous evidence and continuing human oversight.

Like

1

Reply

21 impressions

Evelyne-Claudia Yantony • 1stVerified • 1st

AI Governance & Ethical Intelligence | Author | Scientific Contributor — NeoMundi Research | Living Architecture & Reachable

19h

Sue — this is an important piece.

What stands out most to me is the distinction between historical approval and continuing legitimacy. A system may still be operating exactly as designed while the reality that once justified its authority has already moved.

Your treatment of cumulative materiality sharpens that further: individually tolerable changes can become collectively decisive, especially when no single event appears sufficient to trigger reconsideration.

For me, the critical governance question is therefore not only whether change can be detected, but whether material change can still reach the warrant on which consequential action depends before that action becomes irreversible.

Thank you also for preserving the provenance so carefully. Independent lines of work become stronger when convergence does not erase lineage.

Like

1

Reply1 reply1 Comment on Evelyne-Claudia Yantony’s comment

Sue Broughton Premium**Author**

Gaia Nexus Online

16h

Evelyne-Claudia Yantony Thank you, Evelyne. And I think your addition of whether material change can still reach the warrant is important. Detection alone is not enough. Even where cumulative change becomes visible, governance still depends on that evidence reaching the appropriate authority while meaningful intervention remains possible.

That adds another dimension to continuing reliance for me, not only is the condition still present? and has the change become material?, but can evidence of that material change still reach the point at which an authorised person can act upon it in time? And thank you for your comment on provenance. I agree completely. Convergence becomes much more valuable when we can see both where ideas meet and where they came from.

Like

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16 impressions

[**Ranganath Raghavan** • 1stPremium • 1st]

[Executive Advisor & Growth Leader | Human Judgment, Leadership & Organizational Complexity in the Age of AI | Helping Leaders Navigate Uncertainty with Clarity]

21h

Initial sign-offs age quickly. The system might run fine, but if the assumptions behind the original approval changed, you are operating on borrowed time.

Like

2

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[**Mo Johnson** • 1stPremium • 1st]

[Closing The Accountability Gap™ in clinical and financial AI. Cardiothoracic Surgeon | Applied Research.]

19h

The system can stay unchanged while everything that justified trusting it moves.

Like

1

Reply1 reply1 Comment on Mo Johnson’s comment

Sue Broughton Premium**Author**

Gaia Nexus Online

16h

Mo Johnson Exactly, Mo. And that is the continuity problem in one sentence. The system can remain performant, compliant and unchanged while the evidence that justified relying upon it has materially changed. That is why continuing trust needs continuing evidence.

Like

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19 impressions

Ricardo Muro • 2ndVerified • 2nd

AI Governance Architect | Execution-Bound Validity (EBV) | State Transition Control

17h

Sue, I think this moves the governance question in an important direction. A system can remain technically sound, its controls can continue operating, and the original approval can have been entirely reasonable while the conditions that made reliance reasonable have changed.

The distinction I find especially useful is between preserving the original conditions and preserving the basis for reliance. Not every condition present at approval needs to remain forever; some may legitimately become unnecessary as the organisation and architecture evolve. The harder question is which conditions are still materially necessary now, and what evidence establishes that they remain sufficient.

There may also be a second layer: the indicators used to observe those conditions can change meaning over time. Fewer overrides, for example, could reflect better AI or declining human challenge capability. So longitudinal governance may eventually need to test not only whether the condition persists, but whether the evidence used to infer it still means what we think it means.

That makes “reality moves” more than a drift problem. It becomes a question of whether reliance remains justified by the reality that exists now.

Like

2

Reply1 reply1 Comment on Ricardo Muro’s comment

Sue Broughton Premium**Author**

Gaia Nexus Online

16h

Ricardo Muro Ricardo, yes. I think you have added an important distinction here. The objective cannot be to preserve every condition that existed at approval. Some conditions may legitimately change or become unnecessary. What needs continuity is the basis for reliance and that means asking which conditions remain materially necessary now, rather than treating the original operating model as something that must remain static.

Your second point takes this further. The evidence itself may remain accurate while the meaning we assign to it changes. Fewer overrides could indicate better AI performance, declining human challenge, or something else entirely.

So longitudinal governance may need to test two things over time:
Are the conditions we still rely upon sufficient? Does the evidence we use to assess those conditions still mean what we think it means?

That second question brings us back, interestingly, to the representation problem, an accurate signal can still support the wrong interpretation if the environment around it has changed.
Thank you, this genuinely extends the question.

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14 impressions

Petr Molin • 2ndPremium • 2nd

Digital Transformation & Operations Leader | AI, Data & Business Intelligence | Automation, Operational Excellence & Process Improvement

20h

One implication I took from this is that some approval assumptions probably need to become operating requirements, not just things we monitor.
If an AI deployment was considered safe because experienced reviewers had enough time and capacity to challenge difficult cases, that capacity is part of the design.
Otherwise the business can optimise it away six months later and governance only gets to observe the consequence.
Monitoring tells us the condition is disappearing. The harder question is whether we were supposed to protect that condition in the first place.

Like

2

Reply3 replies3 Replies on Petr Molin’s comment

See previous replies

Sue Broughton Premium**Author**

Gaia Nexus Online

16h

Petr Molin Yes, Petr and I think remembering, is an important word here. Governance needs institutional memory of what the decision actually relied upon, otherwise there is nothing meaningful to compare the changing operating environment against.

And when a material condition no longer holds, the purpose of that evidence is not to make the decision automatically. It is to make sure the question reaches the person authorised to reassess it. That is the difference between detecting change and maintaining governance continuity.

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12 impressions

Charlie Raymond • 2ndVerified • 2nd

VP Strategic Relationships Neurovia Dynamics I Global Pathwys Inc www’global-GPI.com

15h

This is an important distinction: nothing needs to fail for authority to become stale.
The AI may still be functioning exactly as designed. The original approval may remain historically correct. But if the evidence, people, dependencies, obligations or operating conditions supporting that approval have changed, its authority over the next consequence must be re-established.
That is the problem Harmonic addresses at the execution boundary. Before a consequential action proceeds, Harmonic asks whether the conditions required to authorize that action still have present standing—not whether they were once valid or whether the system remains confident.
Coherence can show that a system remains internally consistent. Present contact establishes whether its authority still corresponds with reality. Reality has standing. Past decisions require re-admission.

Like

2

Reply1 reply1 Comment on Charlie Raymond’s comment

Sue Broughton Premium**Author**

Gaia Nexus Online

36m

Charlie Raymond Charlie, yes I think the distinction between historical correctness and present standing is an important one.
Where I see an interesting complementarity is in the timescale and boundary being examined. Harmonic, as you describe it, addresses present standing at the execution boundary before a consequential action proceeds.

The question I am exploring here is broader and longitudinal, whether the human, organisational and operating conditions supporting continuing reliance have materially changed over time, including conditions that cannot necessarily be re-established at each execution boundary.

So I would make one small distinction around past decisions require re-admission. I would not necessarily reopen every past decision before every consequence. Rather, when a condition still material to that decision has changed sufficiently, the basis for continuing reliance may need reassessment.

Perhaps the common principle is, historical validity does not by itself establish present standing. Different governance layers, but a very similar problem underneath them. Thank you, Charlie this is a useful connection.

Like

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3 impressions

HABITS Institute

122 followers

5h

Sue, this is an important distinction. “The decision isn't always what fails. Sometimes reality just moves on” captures a problem we have also been confronting in HABITS.
A decision may have been entirely admissible when made, while the conditions that gave it standing progressively disappear.
Your distinction between latest known state and actual current state is particularly important. Historical authority, intact controls and previous evidence cannot establish present admissibility if the Reality to which they referred has moved.
This is where longitudinal observation and a reality-coupled execution boundary become highly complementary:
observe what is changing over time — but before the next consequence, establish what remains admissible now.
Really thoughtful work, Sue.

Heather

Like

1

Reply1 reply1 Comment on HABITS Institute’s comment

Sue Broughton Premium**Author**

Gaia Nexus Online

34m

HABITS Institute Heather, I think that is exactly the complementarity. Longitudinal observation can show that the conditions supporting reliance are changing over time. But where a consequential action is about to occur, the execution boundary has a different job, establish what still has present standing now.
That distinction matters because historical validity, intact controls and even accurate records do not necessarily establish current admissibility if the reality they referred to has moved.

So I think the two questions sit naturally together:
What is changing over time?

and
Given what is true now, what remains admissible before the next consequence?

Different governance functions, but both protecting against inherited authority becoming detached from present reality.
Thank you, Heather, this is a very thoughtful extension.

Like

Reply

3 impressions